MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, TISSUE, TWEEZERS TYPE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of tissue forceps suitable for use in general surgical procedures.

1.2 Classification. Forceps shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.3).

Size	Length (in inches)
1	5
2	5-1/2
3	6
4	10

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instrument, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Set-Up.

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The tissue forceps shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526, and the following option exercises under that specification.

3.2 Material. The tissue forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4, Type 420 material.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the Rockwell hardness for the tissue forceps shall be C-40 to C-45.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be as indicated below for the appropriate size.

Size 1. Shall be a straight spring type tissue forceps with 2 by 3 teeth, suitable for disection of tissue. Shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

Size 2. Shall be a straight, spring-type tissue forceps, with 1 by 2 teeth. May have post guide with rounded point which shall not extend beyond outer surface of forceps when closed. Shall be suitable for retracting tissue. Shall be in accordance with Figure 2.

Size 3. Shall be a straight, spring-type tissue forceps, 4 by 5 teeth, Stone design, suitable for grasping tissue during general surgical procedures. Shall be in accordance with Figure 3.

Size 4. Shall be a straight, tissue forceps, with 1 by 2 teeth. Shall have post guide with rounded point which shall not extend beyond outer surfaces of forceps when closed. Shall be suitable for grasping tissue. Shall be in accordance with Figure 4.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Finish. Shall be mirror or mirror and satin.

3.6 Identification marking. Instruments of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the stainless steel, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificates shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

Table I Sampling for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	4.0

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Table II Sampling for tests

Unit of product	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Entire forceps	Composition analysis	3.2 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	**	*
	Hardness	3.3 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.5
	Dimensions	3.4	---	S-1	2.5
	Copper sulfate	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.5
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.5

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
** Sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the forceps shall be selected for composition analysis.

4.3 Examination. The tissue forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the following classification of defects. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to, the defects listed in Table III.

Table III Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Instrument not constructed as specified.
103	Instrument not free from sharp edges, rough areas, burrs, cracks, grind marks or overlaps.
104	Serrations not free of foreign matter.
Minor	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Instrument not permanently and legibly marked with either the name or trademark of the contractor.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV Packaging Quantities

Size	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1	1	12	360
2	1	12	360
3	1	12	288
4	1	12	144

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservative. Preservative shall not be applied.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors are acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Special requirements as specified in Table II of PPP-B-636 shall apply for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraph of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed in accordance with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in Table I of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, water-proofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tissue forceps are intended for use in grasping and retaining tissues during general surgical procedures.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification	Size
6515-00-337-9800	FORCEPS, TISSUE, Straight, 5 inch.	1
6515-00-337-9900	FORCEPS, TISSUE, Straight, 5-1/2 inch.	2
6515-00-338-0950	FORCEPS, TISSUE, Stone, Straight, 6 inch.	3
6515-00-338-1200	FORCEPS, TISSUE, Straight, 10 inch.	4

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title or all types which are commercially available.

6.4 Supersession data. This specification includes requirements of Purchase Description No. 13 dated 6 August 1968 for NSN 6515-00-337-9800, 6515-00-337-9900, 6515-00-338-0950, and 6515-00-338-1200.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1884

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

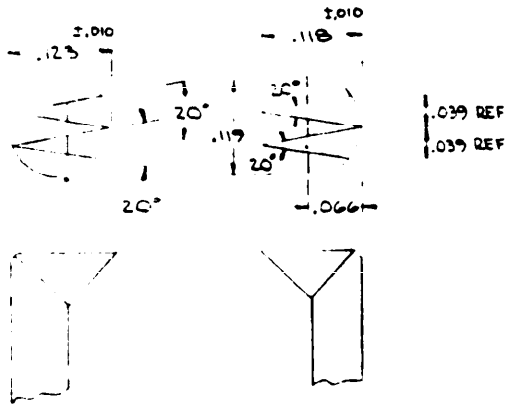
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES:

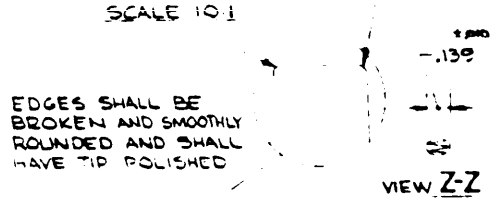
1. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED TOLERANCES SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS:
   ALL DECIMAL DIMENSIONS ..... .001 IN.
   ALL FRACTIONAL DIMENSIONS ..... 1/32 IN.
   ALL ANGULAR DIMENSIONS ..... 2°

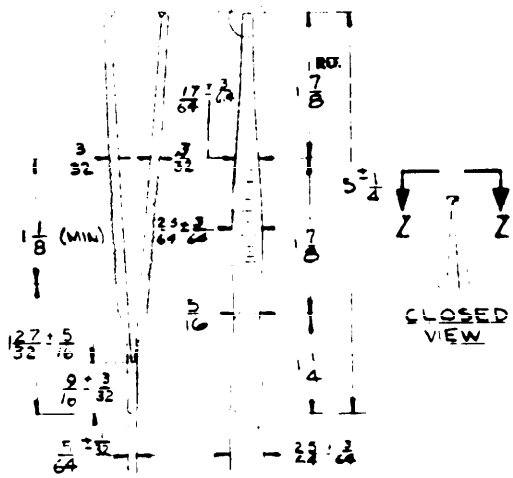
2. TEETH MUST MESH AND MUST BE SHARP, FITTING CLOSELY WITHOUT PLAY. SINGLE TOOTH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO DOUBLE TEETH AND DOUBLE TEETH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO TRIPLE TEETH BUT NOT BEYOND.

3. TOLERANCES INDICATED DELINEATE ACCEPTABLE EXTREME DIMENSIONS, AND ARE NOT INTENDED TO PERMIT VARIATIONS WITHIN A SINGLE INSTRUMENT WHICH WILL SACRIFICE UNIFORMITY, SYMMETRY, AND FIRST QUALITY WORKMANSHIP.



SCALE 10:1





FORCEPS, TISSUE
TWEEZER TYPE, STRAIGHT, 5 INCH
STOCK NO 6515-337-9800

SIZE 1

FIGURE 1

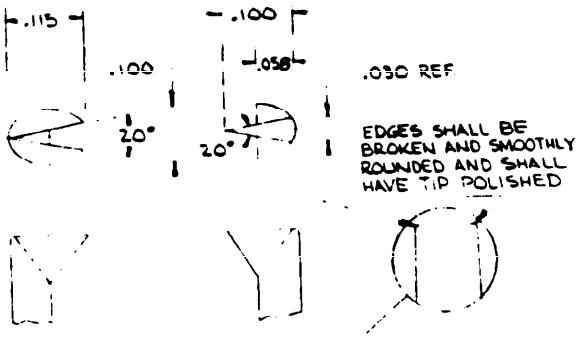
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES:

1. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED TOLERANCES SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS:
   ALL DECIMAL DIMENSIONS ..... .005 I.D. C
   ALL FRACTIONAL DIMENSIONS ..... 1/32 I.D.
   ALL ANGULAR DIMENSIONS ..... 2°

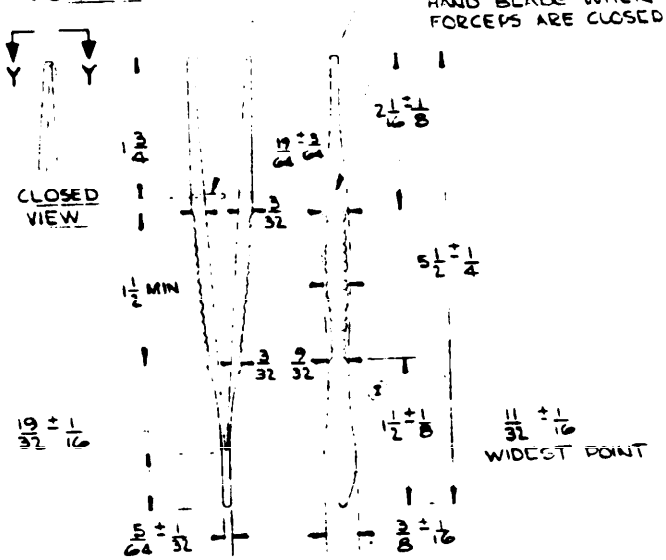
2. TEETH MUST MESH AND MUST BE SHARP, FITTING CLOSELY WITHOUT PLAY. SINGLE TOOTH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO DOUBLE TEETH AND DOUBLE TEETH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO TRIPLE TEETH BUT NOT BEYOND.

3. TOLERANCES INDICATED DELINEATE ACCEPTABLE EXTREME DIMENSIONS, AND ARE NOT INTENDED TO PERMIT VARIATIONS WITHIN A SINGLE INSTRUMENT WHICH WILL SACRIFICE UNIFORMITY SYMMETRY, AND FIRST QUALITY WORKMANSHIP.



SCALE 10:1

PIN (OPTIONAL) IF SUPPLIED PIN TO BE OF SUCH LENGTH AS NOT TO EXTEND ABOVE SURFACE OF EIGHT HAND BLADE WHEN FORCEPS ARE CLOSED



FORCEPS, TISSUE.
TWEEZERS TYPE, STRAIGHT, 5 1/2 INCH
STOCK NO. 6515-337-9900

SIZE 2

FIGURE 2

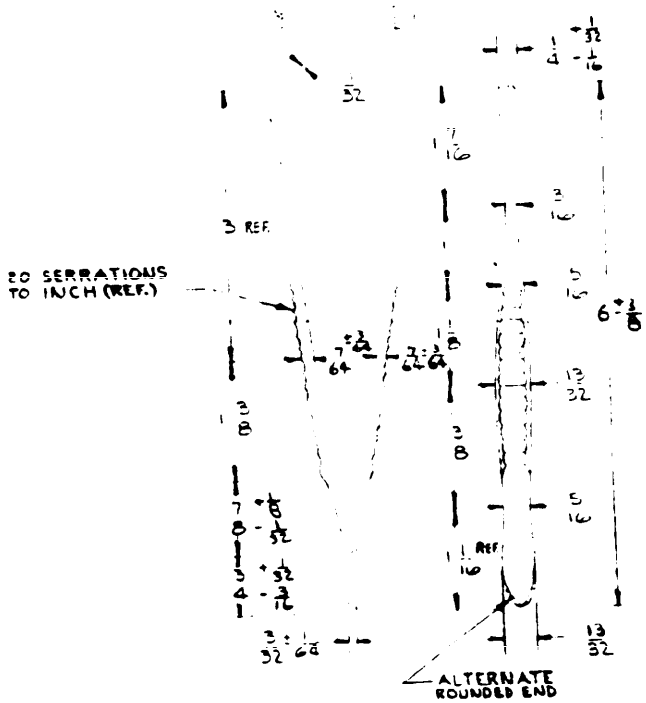
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTES:

1. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED TOLERANCES SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS
   ALL DECIMAL DIMENSIONS ..... .005 IN.
   ALL FRACTIONAL DIMENSIONS ..... 1/32 IN.
   ALL ANGULAR DIMENSIONS ..... 2°

4.2 TEETH MUST MESH AND MUST BE SHARP, FITTING CLOSELY WITHOUT GAP. SINGLE TOOTH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO DOUBLE TEETH AND DOUBLE TEETH MUST EXTEND FULLY INTO TRIPLE TEETH BUT NOT BEYOND.

3. TOLERANCES INDICATED DELINEATE ACCEPTABLE EXTREME DIMENSIONS, AND ARE NOT INTENDED TO PERMIT VARIATIONS WITHIN A SINGLE INSTRUMENT WHICH WILL SACRIFICE UNIFORMITY SYMMETRY, AND FIRST QUALITY WORKMANSHIP



FORCEPS, TISSUE
TWEEZERS TYPE, STONE, STRAIGHT, 6 INCH
STOCK NO. 6515-338-0950

SIZE 3

FIGURE 3

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T09:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.